

allowing you to hide parts of your content. As usual, you can find these permissions under Settings > Privacy. There have been some new options added here. Items like photos, videos, feeds and testimonials can now be made viewable only to your friends.

There's also an option to disable your Orkut profile from appearing in Google's search results! Click on the hide information radio button and click save changes when done.

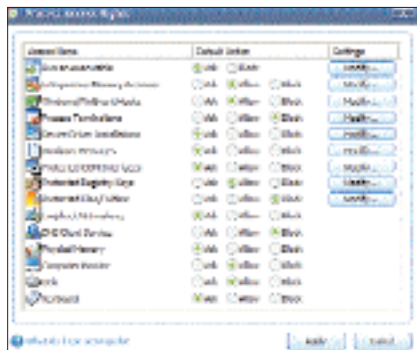
COMODO FIREWALL PRO 3.0

The "Pro" in Comodo Firewall Pro might imply an expensive commercial firewall, but it's available free on their site—<http://personalfirewall.comodo.com> and our CD every month. It's no half-complete software either—it's loaded with features and plenty of options to play around with.

While installing the firewall, be sure to choose Advanced Firewall with Defense+, which gives you more alerts and a few more advanced features.

View Current Connections

Ever wonder which process is hogging all your bandwidth? Comodo Firewall has a feature that allows you



Setting policies and then applying them to programs

to view all the connections going from your PC to the network or Internet and vice versa. Click on the Firewall icon on the top of the window and select View Active Connections.

Here you can see all details such as local and destination ports and IP addresses. You can even force-close a connection by right clicking on it and choosing Terminate Connection.

Disable Popup Alerts

With the Defense+ feature enabled, the pop-ups you'll receive will be more than your patience can handle. You'll get an alert for everything from connection alerts to programs accessing other programs. Right-click on the Comodo

Firewall icon in the system tray and uncheck Display Balloon Messages. Click Apply.

However, if you don't want Comodo Firewall to monitor everything, click on Defense+ and then on the Advanced tab on the left. Click on Defense+ Settings. Select Monitor Settings and then uncheck the activities you don't want monitored. Click Apply.

Quarantining Processes And Programs

Similar to looking for connections made by programs to and from the Internet, Defense+ allows you to look for programs and processes currently active. Like in the Task Manager, you can terminate programs or quarantine them and move them to a safe folder. This is useful to isolate suspicious programs—which might be worms or viruses—on the computer.

Click on Defense+ from the top bar. Select View Active Process List. Here you can right-click on any process and click Terminate (or Terminate And Quarantine to terminate and move the program into quarantine).

Blocking Networks And Machines

To block IP addresses or entire networks, go to Firewall > My Blocked Network Zones. Select Add > A New Blocked Address... Here, you can choose to block IP addresses or range of IPs or even MAC address. Add the required information and then click Apply.

Policies For Software

Policies aren't limited to the network in Comodo Firewall—you can create policies for all kinds of software running on your OS as well. You can



You'll find several types of predefined policies

also create your own custom policies for programs. Go to Defense+ > Advanced tab. Select Predefined Security Policies to view existing policies and to add new ones. You can change the existing policies by clicking on any one, then clicking Edit and choosing Access Rights or Protection Settings.

To create a new policy, click on Add, and set permissions and access rights in

the same manner. To set this policy to an application, click on Computer Security Policy. Select the application you want to set the policy for and click on Edit.

Check the Use a Predefined Policy radio button and then select your custom policy from the drop-down menu next to it.

Parental Control

Now that you have your firewall set up and restrictions in place, you wouldn't want other users to alter the settings all the time. This is done by enabling the parental control. Go to Miscellaneous > Settings. Click the Parental Control tab and check the box to enable password protection for the settings you've made. Click Change Password to set a password.

Submitting Suspicious Files

Every once in a while, you come across a worm or virus that your anti-virus program can't clean or even detect. At such times, use the file submission feature to send the file across to Comodo's developers. Comodo Firewall allows you to upload the files to them so they can analyse and create a possible fix for it. Under Miscellaneous, select Submit Suspicious Files. Click on Add to add files. Add a description and mail ID if required.

Importing And Exporting Settings

Once you're done setting up and tweaking Comodo the way you need it, you want to be able to store and load the settings for future use. You can create profiles and switch to any of them whenever you want.

Go to Miscellaneous and then on Manage My Configurations. Click on Export to export your settings. Give a name and save the file. To import a saved configuration, go to Import > Import and select the file you saved. Now you can switch between profiles by clicking on Select and check from one of the profile. ■



Never lose your settings: you can save them!